

MI-WIC POLICY

Food Package

7.0 Food Package

Effective Date: 03/01/2026

7.01 Food Package Determination and Customization

PURPOSE: To provide direction for the Competent Professional Authority (CPA) to determine the most appropriate food package, including the modification of supplemental foods, to best meet the client's nutritional and other needs.

DEFINITIONS:

Competent professional authority means an individual on the staff of the local agency authorized to determine nutritional risk and prescribe supplemental foods.

Customized food package means a standard food package with individually tailored food substitutions and/or modified quantities that accommodate a client's personal and cultural food preferences and nutrition needs. This also includes food packages with an added WIC formula.

Standard food package means the food package containing the full maximum monthly allowances of authorized foods based on client category. Michigan WIC's standard food package for women and children includes cheese and yogurt substituted for milk, and fruit and vegetable CVB substituted for juice.

A. POLICY

1. All Food Packages I-VII contain at least one food from each allowable food category based on federal regulations for maximum monthly allowances. (See Policy 7.04, Maximum Food Package.) Food categories include milk and milk substitutions (cheese, yogurt, tofu), juice, cereal, eggs, whole grains, fruits/vegetables, canned fish, legumes, WIC formula, and infant foods. (See Policies 7.02, Authorized WIC Foods and 7.03, Food Package for Qualifying Conditions.)
2. The full maximum monthly allowances (MMAs) of all supplemental foods in all food packages must be made available to participants unless medically or nutritionally warranted.
 - a. Providing less than the MMAs or excluding supplemental foods is allowable only after a nutrition assessment and offering substitution options available for individual clients, and when:
 - i. Medically or nutritionally warranted (e.g., to eliminate a food due to an allergy).
 - ii. A client refuses or cannot use the maximum monthly allowances, or chooses to take less than the maximum monthly allowance.
 - iii. The quantities necessary to supplement another program's contribution to fill a medical prescription would be less than the maximum monthly allowances.

- iv. Providing lactation support by tailoring the amount of formula in the partially breastfed infant food package. (See Policy 7.04, Maximum Food Package.)
 - b. Reductions to the MMAs cannot be made for:
 - i. Cost-savings, administrative convenience, caseload management, or to control vendor abuse.
 - ii. Categories, groups or subgroups of WIC clients.
3. The CPA must consider the client's age, food preferences, nutrition assessment, cultural practices, and food storage and preparation abilities when determining the food package.
4. After a complete nutrition assessment, a standard food package must be assigned when the CPA determines no adjustments are necessary to the supplemental foods provided to the client. (See Policies 2.01, Certification/Eligibility; 2.13A, Michigan Nutrition Risk Criteria; and 5.01, Nutrition Services Overview.)
5. After a complete nutrition assessment, if the CPA determines a client's special dietary needs, allergy, cultural practices, and/or personal preferences warrant substitutions to the standard food package, a customized food package must be provided. See Allowable Food Substitutions table below.

Allowable Food Substitutions

Food Item	Allowable Substitution(s)
Milk/Plant-based beverage	Cheese (1 pound = 3 quarts milk) Yogurt (32 ounces = 1 quart milk) Tofu (1 pound = 1 quart milk)
Juice	Fruit and vegetable CVB
Peanut butter	Nut or seed butter*
Eggs	Peanut butter or legumes Nut or seed butter* or legumes Tofu
* Reasons for providing nut or seed butter may include but are not limited to peanut allergy or other special dietary needs and/or cultural preference. Notes: • Standard food packages can be tailored to replace: ○ Cheese and yogurt with milk or plant-based beverage. ○ The extra fruit and vegetable CVB with juice. • Standard food packages contain maximum amounts of cheese - 16 ounces in Food Packages IV-VI and 32 ounces in Food Package VII. (See Policy 7.04, Maximum Food Package.) • A maximum of 64 ounces of yogurt cannot be exceeded in Food Packages IV-VII (See Policy 7.04, Maximum Food Package.)	

6. The CPA may determine based on the nutrition assessment the client needs a different milk or a plant-based beverage.
 - a. Whole milk is the standard milk authorized for children 12 through 23 months of age. Reduced-fat milk (2%) may be substituted for whole milk based on individual nutrition assessment, in consultation with the health care provider as needed, and when one of the following criteria is met and documented:
 - i. Caregiver reports the health care provider recommends 2% milk.
 - ii. Family history of obesity, dyslipidemia, or cardiovascular disease.
 - iii. Client with a weight for length percentile above 97.7 (Risk 115.01).
 - b. Low-fat milk (1%, ½%, and skim or fat free) is the standard milk authorized for women and children 2 through 4 years of age. Reduced-fat milk (2%) may be substituted for low-fat milk based on individual nutrition assessment, in consultation with the health care provider as needed, and when one of the following criteria is met and documented:
 - i. Risk 103.02, "At Risk of Underweight" or 103.01, "High Risk Underweight."
 - ii. Risk 101.01, "Pregnancy Underweight," 102.01, "Postpartum Underweight" or 131.01, "Low Maternal Weight Gain."
 - c. Plant-based beverages may be substituted for any milk, based on individual nutrition assessment for clients who are not receiving a food package for qualifying conditions.
7. For clients on food package III for qualifying conditions (see 7.03, Food Package for Qualifying Conditions):
 - a. The food package must contain at least one WIC formula (for Food Packages IV-VII, this must be manually added).
 - b. Determination for alternative milks or substitutions must be made in coordination with the health care provider and documented on the Special Formula/Food Request DCH-1326.

Reference:

7 CFR 246.10

[Final Rule: Revisions in the WIC Food Packages \(2014\) | Food and Nutrition Service](#)

Cross Reference:

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| 2.01 | Certification/Eligibility |
| 2.13A | Michigan Nutrition Risk Criteria |
| 5.01 | Nutrition Services Overview |
| 7.02 | Authorized WIC Foods |
| 7.03 | Food Package for Qualifying Conditions |
| 7.04 | Maximum Food Package |